

O.R.C.A for Helldivers 2 – F&Q

A. Impact on Base Game

Enhancement, Not a Fix: O.R.C.A doesn't fix anything in Helldivers 2—the game is already fantastic! It's designed to add a little something new without fundamentally changing the game. **I recommend playing HD2 normally first to appreciate Arrowhead's work and to get the full intended experience.** While O.R.C.A isn't primarily designed to compensate for skill gaps, it can help players who struggle with manual stratagem inputs—if that's something that might otherwise cause you to not play the game for example.

Compatible with Manual Inputs: Manual stratagem inputs also work with O.R.C.A active. In fact, when O.R.C.A occasionally fails, you'll probably revert to manual inputs rather than repeating voice commands in heated situations. O.R.C.A neither simplifies nor complicates the game, it offers advantages in some scenarios while manual inputs are still faster in others.

Non-Intrusive: O.R.C.A doesn't replace any original game content, unlike mods that alter voice lines or music. Whether using your wake word or not, you're playing standard Helldivers 2 with all original audio and visuals intact.

B. Impact on Other Players

No Competitive Advantage: Since HD2 isn't a PvP game at the time of writing this, O.R.C.A provides no leaderboard advantages or competitive edge. It offers no monetary benefits like Super Credits and doesn't accelerate resource acquisition. It simply enhances your personal experience, making you feel like Iron Man with AI assistance, and can provide some neat features in some cases.

No Stratagem Hero Minigame: The computer vision system that detects stratagem arrows intentionally doesn't work with the Stratagem Hero minigame on your ship, preventing unfair leaderboard manipulation although I wouldn't be surprised if others have already used a 3rd party program to climb the leaderboard.

C. Is O.R.C.A Cheating?

Technically a mod, but harmless. I would say O.R.C.A qualifies as a cheat or mod since it gives you functions that you wouldn't have without O.R.C.A. However, I also think it's a "harmless" mod: it generates no monetary advantages, doesn't affect competitive leaderboards like Stratagem Hero, and doesn't modify game files or source code. O.R.C.A only utilizes information already available to all players, the same data you see when playing normally. Using O.R.C.A won't make you stand out negatively or ruin other players' experiences; it's simply an alternative way to play.

D. Doesn't VoiceAttack Already Do This?

Yes, it does! Well...sort of. Before starting O.R.C.A, I bought VoiceAttack and went crazy making voice commands for all the stratagems. VoiceAttack works very well (shoutout to the people who made it, it's awesome) and is more general-purpose than what I'm making, I'm essentially creating a Helldivers 2 specific version. I was actually a little surprised to see VoiceAttack on the Steam store given what it does.

At some point I wanted cooldown timers since only the eagle stratagems give you a clear voice line when they come off cooldown. Although VoiceAttack gives you access to basic coding logic like conditional statements (if, then, etc.), I couldn't figure out how to solve certain problems, like some stratagems don't go on cooldown until you use them a certain number of times. For example, the 500kg can have 2 uses if you have the ship upgrade. I'm not saying you definitely can't do this in VoiceAttack, but I couldn't figure it out, so I moved to Python since I knew I could work something out there.

Additionally, I think VoiceAttack uses Windows voice recognition (I could be wrong), which works okay, but there are cases where it won't understand certain words, especially less common ones. O.R.C.A uses a small machine learning model that I fine-tuned on audio clips I recorded, mainly things you'd say in Helldivers 2 plus general phrases. I've found O.R.C.A's voice recognition generally works very well, and I have the benefit of being able to retrain my model if it consistently misses certain words or phrases. I just add a couple clips of the problematic words, retrain the model once, and it usually fixes it. I think I have like 7 versions of the model now.

VoiceAttack also doesn't have the computer vision features that O.R.C.A has. I'm not sure if you can add similar features to VoiceAttack, but that's another Helldivers 2 specific capability.

So, to wrap this up: yes, O.R.C.A is another voice command program similar to VoiceAttack, but more specific to Helldivers 2 and using some interesting tools like machine learning and computer vision.

E. Troubleshooting

If O.R.C.A isn't working: Download and run TestVoiceRecognition.exe from the GitHub repository to see if your commands are being transcribed correctly. Make sure your mic works and try both the default and the mic you are using in the GUI. If the voice commands seem to be working but the inputs are messed up check to make sure your stratagem inputs are set to the arrow keys and not w,a,s,d (this will be changeable in the next version...sorry). Also, you can go to this website and try a few stratagems to see if the inputs go through there (not mine or anything just what I used to test things) :

<https://helldiverstrainingmanual.com/stratagems/interactive-practice>

Finally, you can also try an online keyboard event tracker/key press tracker to see if the voice commands are inputting anything at all.